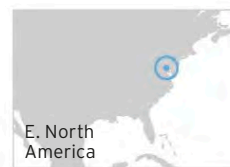


Lincoln Memorial

A monument built to honor the 16th President and to help repair the divisions of the Civil War



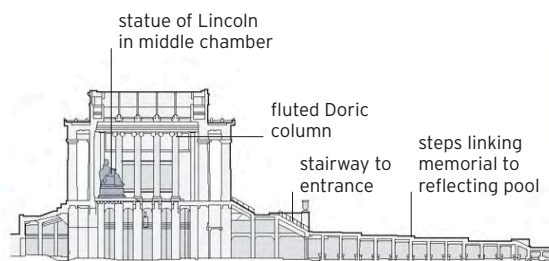
Just as the turmoil of the Civil War was ending, President Abraham Lincoln (1809–1865) was assassinated in Washington, D.C., by a Confederate sympathizer. A simple statue was erected in his honor in 1868, but in response to public demand, the US Senate approved a new, grander memorial in 1910. Designed by Henry Bacon (1866–1924) in the form of a Greek Doric temple, it was built between 1914 and 1922; its construction was delayed by US entry into World War I and wartime shortages of materials.

Immortalized in stone

Within the memorial is a monumental seated statue of Lincoln, made from Georgia white marble, by sculptor Daniel Chester French. Behind the statue are carved inscriptions of two of Lincoln's famous speeches: the Gettysburg Address of 1863 and his second inaugural address of 1865. Standing at the western end of the National Mall, it has been the site of many historic events; most notably, Martin Luther King Jr.'s "I Have A Dream" speech was delivered here on August 28, 1963, at the end of the March on Washington.

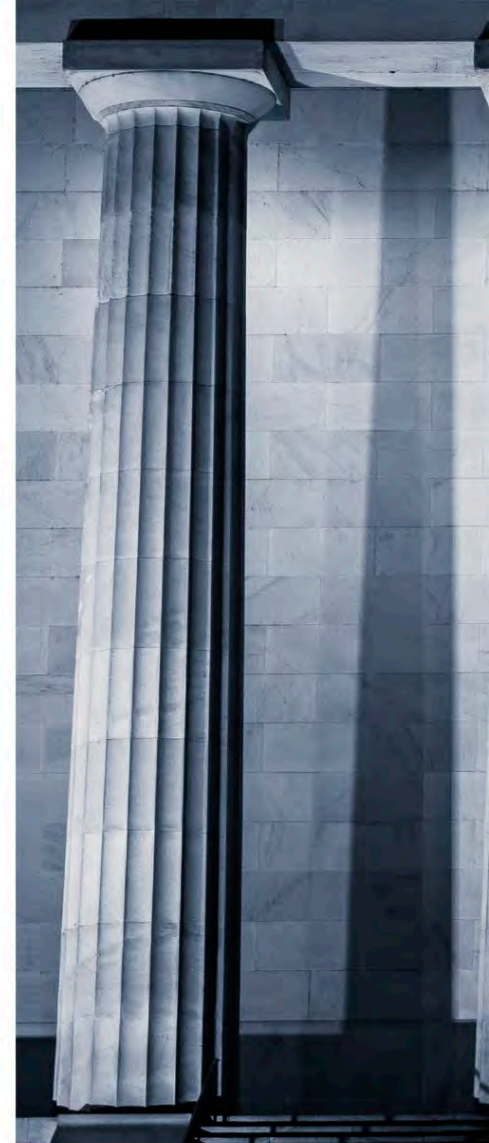
DORIC DESIGN

The memorial stands 98 ft (30 m) high and measures 189 ft by 118 ft (58 m by 36 m). It is surrounded by 36 columns: one for each of the states in the Union at the time of Lincoln's death. The stone used in its construction was sourced from different parts of the US, symbolizing unity.



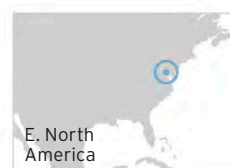
▷ STATELY AND DIGNIFIED

The seated statue of Lincoln was originally intended to be only 10 ft (3 m) tall, but it was enlarged to almost double that size. Under the supervision of the sculptor Daniel Chester French, the sculpture took 4 years to complete.



Jefferson Memorial

A Neo-Classical white marble monument to a great US statesman, thinker, and architect



Thomas Jefferson (1743–1826) is one of the towering figures of American history: the principal author of the Declaration of Independence, written after separation from Great Britain in 1776; the new nation's first ever Secretary of State, under President George Washington from 1790–1793; and its third president, from 1801 to 1809. After retiring from public office, he founded the University of Virginia. Not that he is without reproach, for despite enshrining in the preamble to the Declaration of Independence that "all men are created equal," he was also the owner of many slaves who worked on his Virginia plantation.

A Neo-Classical tribute

Jefferson was an architect as well, designing his own Neo-Classical house at Monticello in Virginia (see pp.24–25), which makes the Neo-Classical

memorial to him in Washington, D.C., all the more apt. Designed by John Russell Pope and begun after his death in 1938, the memorial was officially dedicated by President Franklin D. Roosevelt on April 13, 1943, the 200th anniversary of Jefferson's birth. A 19-ft- (5.8-m-) tall bronze statue of Jefferson by the sculptor Rudolph Evans was placed inside the memorial in 1947, which replaced a bronze-painted plaster statue that was initially installed due to material shortages during World War II. The pediment on top of the main portico features a sculpture depicting the Committee of Five, the five members of the drafting committee of the Declaration of Independence. Excerpts from that declaration and the 1777 Virginia Statute for Religious Freedom—drafted by Jefferson when he was a member of the Virginia General Assembly—are carved on panels on the inside walls.

CIRCULAR STRUCTURE

The Jefferson Memorial consists of a portico with a triangular pediment and a circular colonnade of Ionic columns enclosed by a shallow dome. It is constructed of white Imperial Danby marble from Vermont and is flanked by granite and marble stairs and platforms.

